

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 969

By Vital

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Dr. Benjamin R. Wygal.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Dr. Benjamin R. Wygal; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Wygal was a beloved educator, dedicated public servant, and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on July 16, 1937, in Childress, Texas, Dr. Benjamin R. Wygal began his education in a one-room schoolhouse in West Texas and, through dedication and perseverance, rose to become a college president at the age of thirty-two; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Wygal estimably served for sixteen years as President of Florida Junior College at Jacksonville, where his steady leadership and passion for education left a lasting impact; and

WHEREAS, he continued his career in executive and community leadership roles, serving as President of Life Care Centers of America and later with Adventist HealthCare in Maryland as Vice President of Health and Wellness; and

WHEREAS, for the past twenty-three years, Dr. Benjamin R. Wygal served as Assistant to the President at Southern Adventist University, where he joyfully promoted the university throughout the greater Chattanooga community and found great fulfillment in mentoring, encouraging, and supporting faculty, staff, and especially students; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Wygal had a deep and abiding affection for Southern Adventist University, and his wisdom, kindness, and genuine interest in others made him a cherished presence on campus; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Benjamin R. Wygal shared sixty-nine years of marriage with his beloved wife, Reika, building a life grounded in love, partnership, and unwavering support, and he was a devoted father to his daughters, Kimberly Miller and Kelly Wygal, and a proud grandfather to Ashley Deitering, Cicely Miller, and Emily Newman; and

WHEREAS, he was preceded in death by his parents, Loyd and Pernecia Wygal, and his brother, Jimmy Wygal; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Wygal leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Dr. Benjamin R. Wygal, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction. We express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Dr. Wygal.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.

